

# Main Players in Hedge Funds

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- Educational Presentation #10 – Hedge Funds
- 14.03.2025
- Property of the ESCP Alternative Investments Society
- Sources: Bloomberg, Aurum, FT, Hedgeweek, Hedgefollow, WSJ, Company Websites

# Section I: Introduction

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# L/S and Macro

## L/S Equity:

- Long/short equity strategy profits from mispriced stocks by taking long positions in undervalued stocks and short positions in overvalued stocks
- Gains are made from rising stock prices (long) and falling stock prices (short), allowing flexibility in bull and bear markets
- Success is measured by alpha (excess returns) and beta (market correlation) to assess risk-adjusted performance

## Global Macro:

- Global macro strategy leverages macroeconomic trends to make investment decisions across currencies, commodities, bonds, and equities
- Investment decisions are based on economic indicators (e.g., GDP, inflation, interest rates) using complex econometric models to forecast market shifts
- The strategy profits from global political/economic events, offering diversification and volatility management by capitalizing on price swings from events like geopolitical tensions and central bank policies



# Event-Driven and Quant

## Event-Driven:

- Profits from price movements linked to corporate events like mergers, acquisitions, and restructurings
- Includes merger arbitrage (betting on deal spreads), distressed securities (investing in struggling firms), and activist investing
- Success depends on deal completion, market conditions, and company recoveries, with returns driven by outcomes rather than market movements

## Quantitative:

- Quant funds use mathematical models and statistical analysis to identify market inefficiencies across asset classes
- Trades are executed using automated algorithms, optimizing timing and minimizing human bias
- Strategies rely on risk management models, with success measured by alpha, Sharpe ratio (risk-adjusted returns), and maximum drawdown



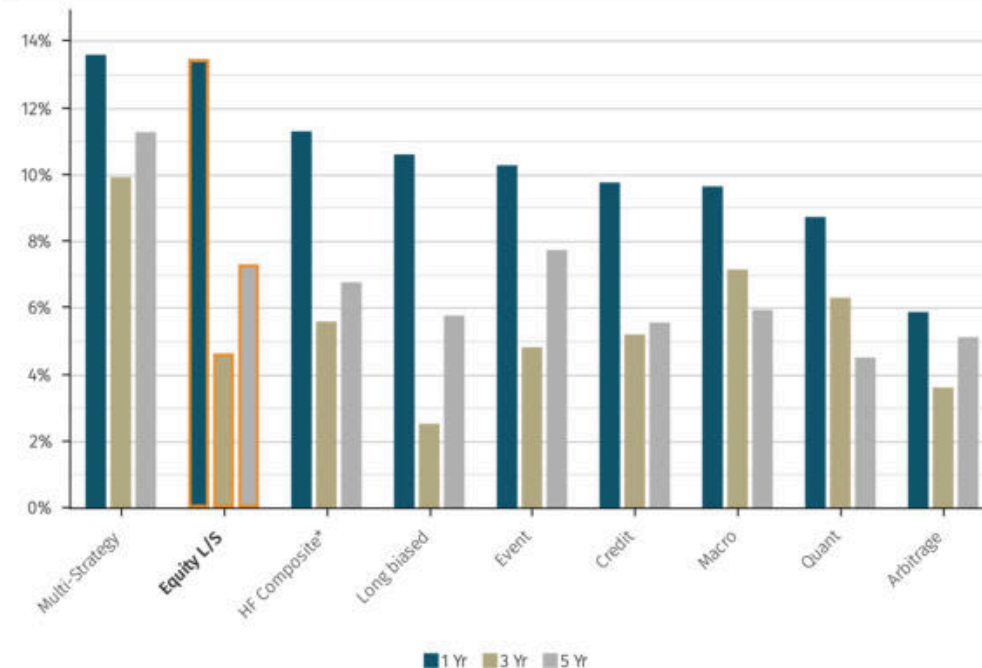
# Compared Performance



## Compared Performance:

- L/S Equity had the highest 1-year returns but weaker 3- and 5-year performance with higher short-term volatility
- Macro and Event-Driven funds delivered steady returns across all periods, while Quant slightly lagged over longer timeframes
- Multi-Strategy has led since 2008, gaining AUM and delivering stable returns through diversification

MASTER STRATEGY NET ANNUALISED RETURNS



## Section II: Multi Strategy / L/S Equity

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# Citadel

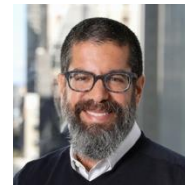


- **Founded:** 1990
- **Founder:** Kenneth C. Griffin
- **HQ:** Miami, US
- **Headcount:** 2 800
- **AUM:** \$62.3bn
- **Returns:** 18% in 2024 (Equity Fund)
- **Strategy:** Multi Strategy including L/S



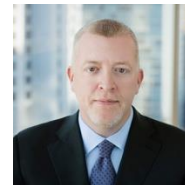
**Kenneth C. Griffin** (Founder & CEO)

- BA from Harvard in Economics
- Founded Citadel in 1990



**Pablo Salame** (Co-CIO)

- BS from Brown in Applied Mathematics
- At Citadel since 2019



**Gerald A. Beeson** (COO)

- MBA from University of Chicago
- At Citadel since 1993

## Recent trade / further detail:

- In early 2025, Citadel has taken a £305m short position in GSK despite its £2bn buyback plan
- Citadel has earned approx. \$8.1bn in 2023 for its investors, bringing their total profit to \$74bn, the highest ever in the Hedge Fund industry
- Citadel's market maker Citadel Securities earned a record trading revenue of \$9.7bn in 2024

- **Founded:** 2014 (previously S.A.C.)
- **Founder:** Steven Cohen
- **HQ:** Stamford, US
- **Headcount:** 2 800
- **AUM:** \$36.9bn
- **Returns:** 19% in 2024
- **Strategy:** Primary L/S



**Steve Cohen** (Founder & CEO)

- BS from Wharton in Economics
- Founded Point72 in 2014



**Andrew B. Cohen** (CIO)

- MBA from Wharton
- At Point72 since 2014



**Gavin O'Connor** (COO)

- MBA from NYU
- At Point72 since 2018

## Recent trade / further detail:

- In early 2025, Point72 raised its stake in Sphere Entertainment to 7.3%, showing confidence despite MSG Networks' \$829m debt talks
- Point72's AI-focused fund gained 14% in three months, nearing \$1.5bn in assets and set to close to new investors by April 2025
- Plans to return up to \$5bn to investors in 2025 after a 19% gain, while shifting some costs to clients



# Millennium

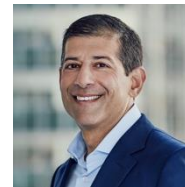


- **Founded:** 1989
- **Founder:** Israel Englander
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 6 100
- **AUM:** \$74.7bn
- **Returns:** 15% in 2024
- **Strategy:** Multi Strategy including L/S



## **Israel Englander** (Founder & CEO)

- BS from NYU in Finance
- Founded Millennium in 1989



## **Ajay Nagpal** (President & COO)

- BA from Brown
- At Millennium since 2013



## **Justin Gmelich** (Co-CIO)

- MBA from Columbia
- At Millennium since 2023

## **Recent trade / further detail:**

- In late 2024 BlackRock was in early talks to acquire a minority stake in Millennium, signalling its push into alternative investments
- In 2024 Millennium invested \$3.3bn in two new trading teams led by two exceptional traders as part of its expansion strategy

# Tiger Global Management

TIGERGLOBAL

- **Founded:** 2001
- **Founder:** Chase Coleman
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 266
- **AUM:** \$58.5bn
- **Returns:** 28.5% in 2023
- **Strategy:** L/S



**Eric Lane** (President & COO)

- BS from Wharton in Engineering
- At Tiger Global since 2021



**Robert Fallon** (Head of Trading)

- MBA from Wharton
- At Tiger Global since 2007



**Don Anderson** (CIO)

- MBA from Bentley University
- At Tiger Global since 2022

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Tiger Global rebounded with a 28.5% gain in 2023, following losses of 56% and 7% in 2022 and 2021 respectively
- In 2023, Tiger Global's VC fund posted an 18% paper loss as it slashed valuations for portfolio companies, including DuckDuckGo (-72%) and OpenSea (-94%)

# Viking



- **Founded:** 1999
- **Founder:** Andreas Halvorsen
- **HQ:** Greenwich, US
- **Headcount:** 275
- **AUM:** \$51bn
- **Returns:** 21% in 2023
- **Strategy:** L/S



**Andreas Halvorsen** (Founder & CEO)

- MBA from Stanford
- Founded Viking in 1999



**Rose Shabet** (COO)

- MBA from Wharton
- At Viking since 2008



**Justin Walsh** (CIO)

- MBA from Harvard Business School
- At Viking since 2010

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Betting on its recovery, Viking acquired a \$526m stake in Boeing in Q4 2024, while also doubling its JPMorgan position to \$1.8bn
- In 2023, Viking has reopened its flagship L/S fund to new capital for the first time since 2011

## Section III: Macro Funds

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# Bridgewater Associates



- **Founded:** 1975
- **Founder:** Ray Dalio
- **HQ:** Westport, US
- **Headcount:** 1 500
- **AUM:** \$154bn
- **Returns:** 11% in 2024 (Pure Alpha fund)
- **Strategy:** Multi Strategy including Global Macro



## Ray Dalio (Founder)

- MBA from Harvard Business School
- Founded Bridgewater in 1975



## Nir Bar Dea (CEO)

- MBA from Wharton
- At Bridgewater since 2015



## Bob Prince (Co-CIO)

- MBA from University of Tulsa
- At Bridgewater since 1986

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Bridgewater increased its Tesla stake by \$62m in Q4 2024 while reducing exposure to the Magnificent Seven tech stocks
- Bridgewater's Pure Alpha fund gained 8.2% in January 2025, navigating AI stock sell-offs and US tariff uncertainties
- Cut workforce by 7% in January 2025

# Brevan Howard

BREVAN HOWARD

- **Founded:** 2002
- **Founder:** Alan Howard
- **HQ:** Jersey, US
- **Headcount:** 1 000
- **AUM:** \$35bn
- **Returns:** 9% 3-year annualized
- **Strategy:** Global Macro



## Alan Howard (Co-Founder)

- MS from Imperial in Engineering
- Co-founded Brevan Howard in 2002



## Aron Landy (CEO)

- PhD from Cambridge in Engineering
- At Brevan Howard since 2003



## Jonathan Hughes (CFO)

- MA from Oxford in Management and Economics
- At Brevan Howard since 2007

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Cut 7% of trading staff after underwhelming performance in 2024, focusing on cost-cutting and operational efficiency
- Brevan Howard's Master Fund gained 5.12% in September 2024, marking its best monthly performance of 2024

# Tudor Investment Corporation

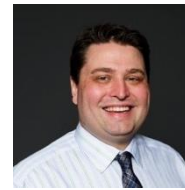


- **Founded:** 1980
- **Founder:** Paul Tudor Jones II.
- **HQ:** Stamford, US
- **Headcount:** 355
- **AUM:** \$63.6bn
- **Returns:** 0.1% 3-year annualized
- **Strategy:** Global Macro



**Paul Tudor Jones II.** (Founder & CIO)

- BA from University of Virginia
- Founded Tudor in 1980



**Clayton Otto** (COO)

- BS from Wharton in Finance
- At Tudor since 2000



**Lorenzo Giorganni** (Global Head of Research)

- PhD from UPenn in Economics
- At Tudor since 2013

## Recent trade / further detail:

- In Q4 2024, Tudor increased its holdings in the iShares Bitcoin Trust by 81%, adding approximately 3.6 million shares to its portfolio
- In Q3 2024, the firm expanded its position in NVIDIA by 400%, acquiring an additional 1,095,156 shares

## Section IV: Event-Driven Funds

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# Elliott Investment Management

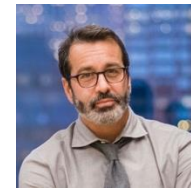


- **Founded:** 1977
- **Founder:** Paul Singer
- **HQ:** Florida, US
- **Headcount:** 593
- **AUM:** \$72.7bn
- **Returns:** 16% 3-year annualized
- **Strategy:** Event-Driven / Activist



**Paul Singer** (Founder, President & Co-CEO)

- JD from Harvard Law School
- Founded Elliott in 1977



**Jonathan Pollock** (Co-CEO)

- BA from Curry College in Management
- At Elliott since 1989



**Zion Shohet** (COO)

- JD from Harvard Law School
- At Elliott since 2015

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## Recent trade / further detail:

- Elliott took a €670m short position in TotalEnergies in March 2025, following its push for BP divestments
- Holding a 5% stake in BP, Elliott is pushing for asset divestments and a leaner cost structure, sparking a battle with 48 institutional investors
- Elliott pressured Honeywell to break up their business, leading to the company's decision in February 2025 to split its aerospace unit

# Pershing Square

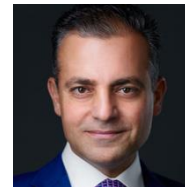


- **Founded:** 2004
- **Founder:** Bill Ackman
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 30
- **AUM:** \$19bn
- **Returns:** 4% 3-year annualized
- **Strategy:** Event-Driven / Activist



**Bill Ackman** (Founder & CEO)

- MBA from Harvard Business School
- Founded Pershing Square in 2004



**Ben Hakim** (President)

- BS from Cornell
- At Pershing Square since 2012



**Michael Gonnella** (CFO)

- BS from Seton Hall University
- At Pershing Square since 2005

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Pershing Square acquired a \$2.3bn stake in Uber in February 2025, citing strong management and growth potential in autonomous vehicles
- In late 2024, Pershing Square built a \$2.6bn stake in Brookfield, signalling confidence in the company's role in global infrastructure
- Sold 2.7% of its stake in UMG in 2025, raising \$1.4 billion. UMG still remains the largest position in their portfolio with 17%



# Third Point

- **Founded:** 1995
- **Founder:** Daniel S. Loeb
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 110
- **AUM:** \$18bn
- **Returns:** 24% in 2024
- **Strategy:** Event-Driven



**Daniel S. Loeb** (Founder & CEO)

- BA from Columbia in Economics
- Founded Third Point in 1995



**Josh Targoff** (President)

- JD from Yale Law School
- At Third Point since 2008



**Ian Wallace** (Co-Head of Credit)

- BA from University of Washington in Management
- At Third Point since 2009

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Third Point's flagship Offshore Fund gained 9.1% in Q4 2024, bringing its full-year return to 24.2%, driven by strong equities and credit
- In early 2025, Daniel Loeb urged SoHo House's board to open its sale process to outside bidders, criticizing the existing offer as undervalued
- Third Point agreed to acquire credit fund manager AS Birch Grove, to expand its credit platform, particularly in CLOs and private credit

## Section V: Quant Funds

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# Renaissance Technologies



- **Founded:** 1982
- **Founder:** Jim Simons
- **HQ:** Greater New York, US
- **Headcount:** 300
- **AUM:** \$89bn
- **Returns:** 30% in 2024 (Medallion Fund)
- **Strategy:** Quant



## **Jim Simons** (Founder)

- PhD from Berkeley in Mathematics
- Founded Renaissance in 1982



## **Peter Brown** (Co-CEO)

- BA from Harvard
- At Renaissance since 1993



## **Mark Silber** (CFO)

- JD from NYU
- At Renaissance since 1983

## **Recent trade / further detail:**

- Renaissance's Medallion Fund gained 30% in 2024, while its institutional funds returned 22.7% and 15.6%
- Renaissance added over 1M GameStop shares in Q1 2024 and increased its AMC stake by 78%, benefiting from the meme stock surge
- The Medallion Fund posted a stunning 76% return in 2020, averaging 30% net since its creation

# D.E. Shaw

- **Founded:** 1988
- **Founder:** David E. Shaw
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 2 500
- **AUM:** \$65bn
- **Returns:** 36% in 2024 (Oculus Fund)
- **Strategy:** Multi Strategy including Quant



## David E. Shaw (Founder)

- PhD from Stanford
- Founded D.E. Shaw in 1988



## Eddie Fishman (COO)

- BS from Princeton
- At D.E. Shaw since 1995



## Anne Dinning (Chair of the Executive Committee)

- PhD from NYU in Computer Science
- At D.E. Shaw since 1990

### Recent trade / further detail:

- D.E. Shaw raised \$1bn for its Alkali VI fund, focused on corporate and structured debt, bringing total Alkali capital to \$3.9bn
- In late 2024, D.E. Shaw took a €102m short position on Bayer following a sharp drop in the company's stock after weak earnings and CEO warnings

# Two Sigma Investments



- **Founded:** 2001
- **Founder:** John Overdeck, David Siegel, Mark Pickard
- **HQ:** New York City, US
- **Headcount:** 2 000
- **AUM:** \$60bn
- **Returns:** 10% in 2024 (Spectrum Fund)
- **Strategy:** Multi Strategy including Quant



**David Siegel** (Co-Founder)

- PhD from MIT in Computer Science
- Co-founded Two Sigma in 2001



**Scott Hoffman** (Co-CEO)

- JD from NYU
- At Two Sigma since 2023



**Carter Lyons** (Co-CEO)

- BS from Lehigh University
- At Two Sigma since 2011

## Recent trade / further detail:

- Two Sigma is launching a real estate fund to raise external capital, focusing on housing, industrial properties, and select commercial assets
- Two Sigma is negotiating a \$100m settlement with the SEC over trading misconduct related to unauthorized changes in trading models by a former employee in 2024



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